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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Hello, my name is Andrew Leamon and I am a writer of comic books and marketing copy. Professional writing has many challenges from writer's block to maintaining steady work, but the greatest challenge and existential threat to writing -- one of the oldest and most revered occupations is artificial intelligence and the overreach by artificial intelligence companies.

More specifically, the regulations (or lack thereof) that AI companies like OpenAI are openly seek to destroy creative industries and millions of lives with no net benefit. They want no oversight and all the copyright protection. I have personally witnessed the damage of ChatGPT's introduction to my industry. Many of my colleagues have been laid off and replaced by inaccurate and regularly hallucinating technology. Many writers are finding their works plagiarized. Many schools are finding student papers are generated on ChatGPT. This is unacceptable on every single level.

Now OpenAI has gone to the president and stated that China's emerging AI company is stealing data so they should be allowed to as well.

With the rate of the billions and billions of dollars that OpenAI and their Chinese rival keep wasting, they will not be in business for much longer. That is not something the American people should worry about.

American and Chinese Investors know that AI is too much of a risk and they will be dropping out in the coming months. That is not a cause for urgency, but ease.

The enormous financial and environment costs to maintain AI data centers alone is not worth protecting.

The possible revenue AI *could* generate doesn't come close to the revenue writers and artists *actually* generate as freelance and as salaried workers. Regulations exist to protect workers and consumers, not companies.

Allowing OpenAI to steal writers' works is not just a spit in the face to hardworking Americans, it is a terrible waste of money and resources.

I urge this body to avoid any regulatory actions that would harm writers and artists. We are the lifeblood of every industry and deserve every protection over a money and energy wasting company that seeks to strip us of our protections.

AI companies want to steal our works for their financial gain, but we must tell them no. Tearing down protections for writers and artists will only make things worse for all Americans. It will not keep us competitive. It will not provide anyone except OpenAI any actual benefit.

I urge the body to follow precedent and keep regulatory, copyright and privacy laws in tact.